



The monastery of Santissima Annunziata in Florence.

The monks there gave him a place to live and a workshop to paint in. Here he began working on a drawing in charcoal and black and white chalk. It was another biblical scene, this one of the Virgin Mary, the baby Jesus, St. Anne, and John the Baptist. These kinds of drawings were often called cartoons. Leonardo never went any further than the detailed drawing. However, his skill was so great that, as Vasari noted, the drawing “caused all the craftsmen to marvel.”